IDRIS OLUBISI, Senior Developer Relations Engineer

heedris2olubisi@gmail.com | Github | Portfolio | Linkedin | www.idrisolubisi.com
London, United Kingdom | UK Global Talent visa (Tech Nation endorsed), no sponsorship needed

PROFILE SUMMARY

Backend engineer turned developer relations engineer, now building agent systems, with seven years across backend engineering and developer-facing work. Sits close to the people using a system, finds the step that costs them time, and ships the fix as production software, tooling or teaching. Built the open-source Midnight MCP server (10,000+ downloads, 11,900+ agent tool calls) and SwoopAgent, a live multi-tenant platform where around 100 users trade real funds through Claude-powered agents behind an independent safety layer. As the first developer-relations engineer on the team at a blockchain infrastructure company, supported 100,000+ developers at a 4.8/5 rating and cut integration setup time 55% with a reference implementation. Earlier, built a multi-tenant payment service that served 50,000+ users at 99.9% uptime, and led a backend team. Author of 40+ tutorials read 10M+ times and founder of Web3 Afrika (15,000+ builders). London-based, no sponsorship required.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Agent harness: tool use and MCP servers, context management, orchestration, verification gates, human-in-the-loop approval, safety layers independent of the agent, agent session observability, usage analytics. Claude and OpenAI APIs. Claude Code, Cursor and Codex. Local inference with Ollama, GGUF models and RAG.
Backend: TypeScript, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Redis, Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, event-driven and microservice architectures, REST and GraphQL, WebSockets, Neo4j, Elasticsearch. Earlier: .NET Core, SharePoint.
Frontend: React, Next.js, Vue, Vite, Vitest.
Correctness and reliability: atomic transactions, optimistic locking, idempotency keys, rate limiting, monitoring and alerting, performance profiling, zero-data-loss migrations.
Delivery: GitHub Actions CI, Docker, Cloudflare Workers, Vercel, Supabase, release runbooks, on-call rotations.
Web3: Solidity, Foundry, Axelar GMP, Compact and zero-knowledge smart contracts.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Developer Educator, Developer Relations – Midnight Foundation, Remote **Sept 2025 - Present**

- Built and open-sourced the Midnight MCP server, with a hosted compiler as a verification gate so AI coding assistants returned code that compiles: 10,000+ downloads, 11,900+ agent tool calls. Built over a weekend from a pattern seen in support.
- Led the docs overhaul for AI retrieval (server-side rendering, llms.txt), ran the docs AI assistant, and used 784 of its questions (15% unanswered) to decide which docs, tutorials and videos to produce.
- Launched Midnight Academy (1,576 enrolled, 1,120+ certified), and built Compact by Example and Compact Playground, which compiles Compact contracts from the browser, plus a 12-part video series.
- Ran two content-bounty cohorts with a compile-gated, mechanically verified review pipeline; the second cohort published 20 tutorials.
- Kept the example repositories production-current: SDK migration audit, CI on every repo, release monitoring, on-call rotation and a 48-hour triage, fix, test, ship runbook. Landed fixes upstream.
- Ran partner integrations end to end with engineering leads and fed reproducible findings to Product and Engineering. Built create-mn-app (9,000+ npm downloads). Taught a University of Zurich summer school session.

Developer Relations Engineer – Axelar / Interop Labs, Remote **April 2023 - Aug 2025**

- Provided critical go-to-market (GTM) and integration support for strategic partners, helping them launch and scale their cross-chain applications.
- Supported 100,000+ developers with hands-on integration debugging, rated 4.8/5.
- Built foundry-axelar-gmp-example, reducing cross-chain dApp setup time by 55% and driving 500+ weekly developer activations

- Acted as a key solution architect, designing and validating technical blueprints for projects building on Axelar, ensuring robust and efficient implementations.
- Grew documentation usage 120% with rewritten docs and interactive tutorials. Ran workshops and live-coding sessions with partners such as Moralis, Linea and Scroll, and fed onboarding drop-off data into product priorities.

Developer Relations Engineer – Mara, Nairobi **Jul 2022 - April 2023**

- Cut developer onboarding time by 65% by designing and implementing an optimized documentation-to-production workflow
- Scaled Mara Developer Campus Club from 0 to 18+ universities, establishing sustainable partnerships
- Reached 30,000+ developers across Africa through conferences, hackathons, bootcamps, and technical workshops
- Created and managed technical content for the Mara Academy platform, growing membership to 19,000+ developers with an 85% monthly retention rate
- Ran the feedback pipeline from developers into product and managed strategic partners across regions.

Backend Engineer – Luna, London (remote) **Dec 2021 - Jul 2022**

- Improved application performance by 63% through systematic bottleneck identification, code optimization, and microservices architecture implementation
- Built a multi-tenant payment service serving 50,000+ users, integrating Stripe, PayPal and bank payment APIs, with Apache Kafka as the event-streaming layer between services.
- Sustained 99.9% uptime with monitoring and alerting, and mentored three junior engineers on system design.
- Built the application's authentication and encryption layer.

Backend Engineer (promoted to backend team lead) – PhilanthroLab, Dallas (remote) **Feb 2021 - Dec 2021**

- Built most of the backend infrastructure and shipped the MVP.
- Promoted to backend team lead: led technical programmes, system design, code reviews, documentation and architecture decisions.
- Designed and built an automated data lake processing 100 GB+ a month, replacing manual retrieval with queryable datasets.
- Improved application performance 50% with GraphQL, Node.js, Neo4j and Elasticsearch, and automated workflows that save 1,000+ hours a year.

Software Developer / Support Analyst – Tavia Technologies **Apr 2019 - Jan 2021**

- Built custom .NET Core and SharePoint solutions for enterprise clients: Access Bank, MTN Nigeria (part of MTN Group, Africa's largest mobile operator) and NPDC (NNPC's exploration and production arm).
- Provided enterprise support and issue resolution, managed test-to-production deployments, backups and database migrations with zero data loss, and wrote documentation for knowledge transfer.
- Saved 900+ hours of manual work annually by automating business processes for enterprise clients, including MTN Nigeria, NPDC, and Access Bank

SPEAKING AND WRITING

Speaking: University of Zurich International Summer School (2026): guest lecture on Midnight. **Blockfest Africa 2025, Lagos**: keynote, "Beyond H-1B: Building Global Tech Careers from Africa". **Midnight (2025/26)**: fireside chat on AI-assisted developer tooling, with a demo of the Midnight MCP server. **ETHCC (2025)**: speaker. **Build Afrika Summit** (2025, Lagos): founder and host. Devcon (2024): speaker. Osmocon (2023, Paris): "Cross-Chain Interoperability with Axelar Network". DevFest Lagos (2022): "Leveraging USDC to build decentralised applications in Web3 efficiently". CityJS Conference (2022): "JavaScript Supremacy: Building a scalable full-stack application with JavaScript". Writing:

40+ technical tutorials, 10M+ total reads across all platforms; 200,000+ readers a year on the personal blog. Published on freeCodeCamp, LogRocket, Section, Moralis, dev.to and Hashnode

EDUCATION

- **B.Eng. Electrical and Electronics Engineering** - Abubakar Tafawa Balewa University, Bauchi State **2018**

MENTORSHIP & VOLUNTEER

- Founder of Web3 Afrika, A builders community with over 15,000 builders across the continent
- Mentored and led the Backend community at the SheCodeAfrica community, with over 50,000 active members learning to code in 15 African countries.
- OSCA Hero, Open Source Community Africa: open source, technical writing and OSCAFEST organising.